Paper 6 — how to read a case (one page)

The paper is always the same shape

- 5 cases. Do 4. Each case: 5 MCQs (2 marks) + 3 long answers (4–6 marks).
- 4 hours = 60 min per case. About 10 min reading, 6 min per question.
- Each case has one question from each subject: FR, AFM, Audit, Law, Direct Tax, GST/Customs, Costing/Strategy.
- The 8 questions never depend on each other. Do them in any order. Skipping one hurts only that one.

Step 1 — read the 8 questions first (2 min)

Write the subject next to each question in the margin. Now you know which paragraphs matter before you read them.

Step 2 — read the case with a pen (8 min)

Mark three things:

1. **Hinges** — a person, a date, or a deadline introduced in one paragraph that a later paragraph quietly relies on. Example: "CA L is the internal auditor" (para 7) is what makes the GST paragraph (para 8) exist. "Payment due 31 January" is what makes the whole import paragraph work. Circle these. They connect two subjects.

2. **Reused numbers** — any amount with a currency, a date, and a rate (e.g. "Euro 15,000 each, 15% block, paid 31 Jan"). One such number was used by three questions from three subjects (Customs, AFM, Income-tax). Box it.

3. **Colour** — sentences with no number, no date, no name of a law. ("The company values dividend stability", "new entrants are a concern", "the board is diverse.") No question is built on these. Skim.

Step 3 — before answering a long question

Ask: "Does this need facts from two different paragraphs?" Two of the eight did (GST rate + place of supply; share price needing the 70% retention policy from a different paragraph). If you answer from one paragraph only, you lose the mark.

Step 4 — choosing which case to drop

Drop the one where the same numbers are pulled into questions from the most different subjects. Those cases take the longest per mark. (May-26 Case 1 reused facts about 5x more than Jan-26 Case 1. Checked on two cases only — treat as a tie-breaker, not a law.)

If one answer feels wrong

Don't re-read the whole case. A misread paragraph affects at most 1–2 questions. Fix that one and move on.

Two more things (checked on the papers)

Short paragraphs are worth the most. The 10-line paragraph with several numbers and a "plans to / ordered / payment due" sentence was worth 8–12 of the 25 marks in both cases. The long company-story paragraph was worth 2–5. Spend your reading time on the short dense ones, not the long ones.

Dense paragraphs carry decoy numbers. In the import paragraph four exchange rates were given (106, 107, 108, 109) and only one is correct. The mark is for knowing *which date picks which rate*, not for finding a number. When you see three or four similar numbers, stop and write down the rule before computing.

The index you carry (build this at home)

The book index goes *name of the law → page*. The paper never gives you the name of the law. It gives you facts. So you need the reverse: *facts → page*. Seven sheets, one per subject, stapled at the front of your binder.

Which sheet? The shape of the facts tells you

What the paragraph gives you	Sheet
A person with a job title doing something (EQCR, engagement partner, internal auditor, chief accountant)	Audit
A count, a %, or a ladder of prices (14 directors, 91%, 170 / 180 / 190)	Law
Terms of an instrument (face value, coupon, convertible into N, redeemable after N years)	FR
Rates in pairs (spot / forward, borrow / deposit, India / abroad)	AFM
Dates + a place + an amount + a rate change	GST / Customs
WDV, block %, "put to use" dates, crore amounts	Direct Tax
Nouns with no numbers (segments, suppliers, channels, sustainability)	Strategy / Costing

What one line on a sheet looks like

Each line = **2–3 facts together → book + page → the rule**. One fact alone is ambiguous; two or three together are unique.

``` GST | advance received · invoice after supply · rate changed between → s.14 CGST | GST book, p.__ rule: 2 of 3 events (supply / invoice / payment) before the change → old rate

Customs | FOB in foreign currency · several exchange rates · BoE date ≠ arrival date → s.14 + s.15 Customs | Customs book, p.__ rule: exchange rate = CBIC on BoE date; duty rate = later of BoE / arrival

Law | holding above 90% · valuer price · highest price paid · negotiated price → s.236 Companies Act | Law book, p.__ rule: higher of valuer and highest paid; extra paid to some must be shared pro-rata ```

The rule line matters as much as the page. The page tells you the law; the rule tells you which of the four numbers in the paragraph to use.

## Three kinds of material, not one stack

1. **Trigger sheets** (above) — 7 pages, front of binder. Used on every question.
2. **Procedure sheets** — for AFM, Direct Tax, GST, Customs, FR: the steps of each computation plus its selector rules. Used for the short dense paragraphs (the 8–12 mark ones). No book helps here in 6 minutes.
3. **Framework lists** — for Strategy / Costing: BMC 9 blocks, Porter 5, BSC 4, Kano, cost of quality 4. Used for the long narrative paragraphs. Pure lookup.

The books are where the page points. You open one book at one page, once, per question. You never browse.

## How to use it in the hall (60 seconds)

question stem → subject → scan that paragraph → match 2–3 facts on the sheet → read page + rule → open the book at that page → cross out the decoy numbers with the rule → write.

## Building it

For every past question (RTP, MTP, past papers): write the 2–3 facts that triggered it, the law/standard, the book and page number in *your* copy, and the rule that picked the right number. That is one line. ~150 lines covers three sittings.
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What keeps coming back (6 sittings, 240 questions)

Asked in **every one** of the six papers — make procedure sheets for these first: - ITC — blocked, reversed, 180-day, time limit, transfer, Rule 86B (14 questions) - Place & time of supply, RCM, valuation (14 questions) - Directors — appointment, disqualification, limits, remuneration, loans (11 questions) - Leases, PPE, intangibles, forex (Ind AS 116 / 16 / 38 / 21) (11 questions) - Forex hedging & currency risk (10 questions) - Business income & depreciation computations (9 questions)

Asked in five of six: - Other AFM — bonds, FRA, RADR, EAC, GDR, EMA, distressed securities (10) - Audit report: modifications, EOM/OM, KAM, summary & special-purpose (9) - Quality, lean, TQM, NVA, TPM, kaizen, supply chain (9) - Customs — valuation, duty date, warehousing, refund, FTP (8) - Tax procedure — SCN, appeals, rectification, updated return, penalties (8) - TDS (7) - Valuation & M&A arithmetic (6)

Four of six: strategy frameworks (14 questions — one page per framework), charitable trust / FCRA, Ind AS presentation & errors, FEMA, relevant costing & pricing.